

The University of Newcastle
School of Computer and Information Sciences

COMP3851A – Computing and Information Sciences
WIL
Project Charter

Newcastle Smart Peer Companion:
AI-Assisted Peer Collaboration Platform

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Project Guidance and Sponsors:

Name	Category
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Dr V Sithira Vadivel	Project Sponsor
Jade Ong	Project Sponsor

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1. Project Title

Newcastle Smart Peer Companion: AI-Assisted Peer Collaboration Platform

2. Project Overview

The Newcastle Smart Peer Companion is an AI assisted peer collaboration platform for university students. It's made to feel like a study group chat, where students can talk about learning materials with other peers and when things get a bit tricky, they can bring in AI to help them.

The goal of our group is to encourage peer learning and cooperative work while also keeping the AI as a supporting tool, not something that should substitute student discussion or critical thinking.

3. Problem Statement

The use of AI tools is rapidly increasing for university students but most of the time they work with it alone. That could lower the chances for peer talk, shared logic and harder inspection of what the AI gives back.

So, this project is about setting up a study platform, where students can cooperate with each other while still getting AI help only when it's needed.

4. Project Purpose

The whole point of this project is to design and plan an AI assisted peer collaboration platform, kind of like a guided space for people to work together more smoothly.

In Part A, the team will do more digging, like research, figuring out requirements, then validation, after that the design decisions and all the documentation that comes with it.

In Part B, the team shifts to build mode, development, testing, ongoing improvement, and then the final delivery part.

5. Project Objectives

1. To investigate how AI can support peer collaboration in university learning.
2. To review existing AI and chat-based tools.
3. To gather student feedback through a sentiment survey.
4. To define the platform's main requirements.
5. To prepare the design and planning documents needed for Part B.

6. Project Scope

Included in Scope

- Literature review on peer collaboration and AI-assisted learning
- Review of existing AI and chat-based platforms
- Student sentiment survey
- Stakeholder and requirements analysis
- Mental model and conceptual model
- Figma UI/UX exploration
- Cybersecurity, privacy, consent, and ethics planning
- Project Charter, Gantt Chart, Project Plan, and meeting minutes

Excluded / Future Enhancements

- Full production deployment
- Full-scale student rollout
- Advanced handwritten note recognition
- Enterprise-level cybersecurity
- Large-scale cloud hosting

7. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role / Interest
Students	Main users of the platform
Project Sponsors	Provide project direction, feedback, and approval
Guidance Advisor	Provides academic and project guidance
Lecturers	May benefit from improved student collaboration and responsible AI use
Development Team	Plans, designs, validates, and develops the project
University	Concerned with academic integrity, privacy, and responsible AI use

Table 1: Project Stakeholder

8. Project Team and Roles table

Member	Role	Main Responsibilities
Krish Longwani – C3549511	Project Manager / AI & Data Engineer	Leads project coordination, manages team progress, supports Llama 3.1 setup, AI research, and Python PDF parsing
Alas Elizabeth Louise Flores – C3546059	Documentation Lead / Cybersecurity Support	Handles meeting minutes, Gantt chart, pre-project planning, project plan formatting, document consistency, user consent, and cybersecurity considerations
Berezovik Daniil – C3543315	Front-End & UI Developer	Works on React/Vite front-end, Figma UI design, chat interface design, and user experience
Hein Myat Thu – C3552370	Back-End Architecture	Works on Python API planning, user authentication, back-end logic, and system structure
Kaung Sett Paing Tun – C3546060	Database & Integration Engineer	Handles PostgreSQL/vector database research, data storage planning, and system integration

Table 2: Project Team Roles and Responsibilities

9. Project Management Approach

The team will be using an Agile/Scrum inspired approach. Work will be handled by breaking it into smaller tasks, with regular meetings and constant progress updates.

The team will use:

- Notion Kanban board for task tracking
- SharePoint for documents and reports
- GitHub for coding files
- Figma for UI/UX design
- Regular meetings for updates and sponsor feedback

Project Stage	Focus
Part A	Research, requirements, validation, design, planning, and documentation
Part B	Development, testing, refinement, and final delivery

Table 3: Project Stages

10. Timeline and Colored Gantt Chart

The project sponsors recommended using a colored Gantt chart to help plan and track how the project timeline moves like a steady visual route. The Gantt chart will cover the 24-week project period, which includes Part A and Part B, without leaving anything out.

The Gantt chart will remain as a separate document from the meeting minutes and will be updated as the project progresses, little by little.

10.1 Proposed Gantt Chart Color Legend

Color	Project Activity	Colors
Red	Meetings and sponsor discussions	
Orange	Stakeholder discussions and survey activities	
Yellow	Documentation and reporting	
Green	Database design and data planning	

Turquoise	Software design and system architecture	
Blue	Interface design and Figma prototyping	
Purple	Specification, requirements, and models	
Violet	Integration and AI planning	
Pink	Initial testing and validation	
Dark Red	System testing and refinement	
Brown	Demonstration, final report, and presentation	
Gold	Finishing and final submission	

Table 4: Gantt Chart Colour Legend

10.2 Part A Gantt Chart: Week 1 to Week 12

Project Activity	W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6	W7	W8	W9	W10	W11	W12
Meetings and sponsor discussions												
Project charter												
Stakeholder discussions and student survey												
Literature review and existing AI tool review												
Functional and non-functional requirements												
Mental model and conceptual model												

UI/UX research and Figma prototype												
Database and data planning												
Software design and system architecture												
Cybersecurity, ethics, privacy, and consent												
Project Plan drafting and review												
Part A final review and submission												

Table 5: Part A Gantt Chart, Week 1 to Week 12

10.2 Part B Gantt Chart: Week 13 to Week 24

Project Activity	W1 3	W1 4	W1 5	W1 6	W1 7	W1 8	W1 9	W2 0	W2 1	W2 2	W2 3	W2 4
Part B development setup												
Front-end development												
Back-end development												

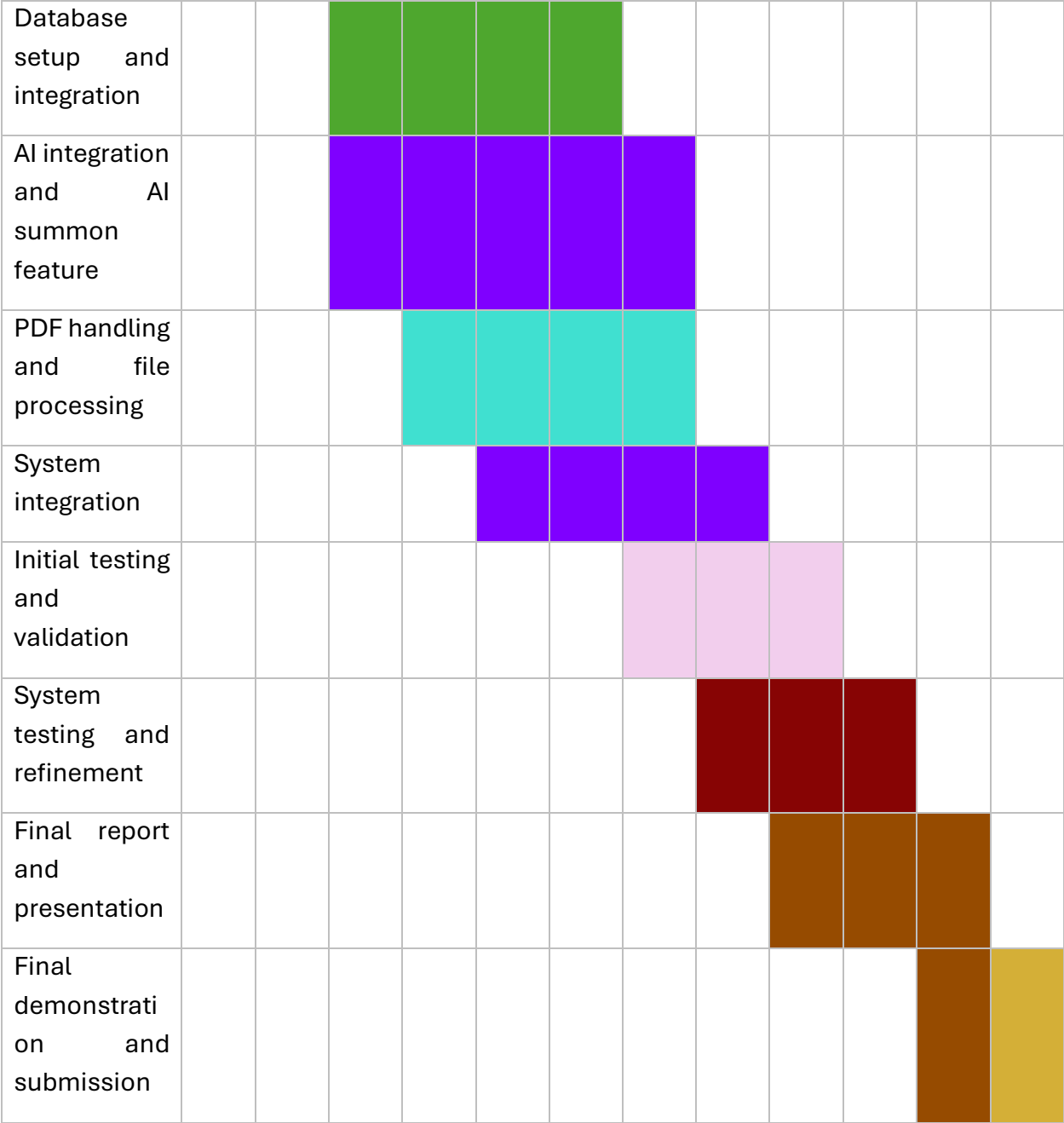


Table 6: Part B Gantt Chart, Week 13 to Week 24

11. Deliverables

The main deliverables for this project are listed in Table 4. These deliverables will help the team track the project outputs for both Part A and Part B.

Deliverable	Description
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Project Charter	A short document that confirms the project direction, team roles, scope, timeline, and approvals.
Meeting Minutes	Records of group meetings, sponsor meetings, decisions, and action items.
Colored Gantt Chart	A 24-week project timeline showing the main tasks for Part A and Part B.
Literature Review Summary	A summary of research articles related to peer collaboration, AI-assisted learning, and higher education.
Student Sentiment Survey	A survey used to collect student feedback and support the need for the project.
Requirements List	A list of functional and non-functional requirements for the platform.
Mental Model and Conceptual Model	Diagrams or explanations showing how students may understand and use the platform.
Figma Prototype	An initial UI/UX design of the study-focused group chat platform.
Project Plan	The formal COMP3851A Project Plan assessment document.
Final Prototype	A working prototype to be developed in Part B.
Final Report and Presentation	Final project documentation and seminar presentation.

Table 4: Project Deliverables

12. Initial Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Possible Impact	Mitigation	Responsible
Unclear project scope	Team may focus on the wrong features	Confirm expectations with project sponsors and record decisions in meeting minutes	Krish / Elizabeth
Limited research evidence	Weak project justification	Each member will review at least two articles related to peer collaboration, AI-assisted learning, or higher education	All members
Low survey response rate	Insufficient validation data	Share the survey early with relevant students and follow up where appropriate	Krish / Hein
AI integration difficulty	Delay in Part B development	Begin AI research early and identify backup options if full integration is difficult	Krish

Privacy and security concerns	Risk involving uploaded files, chat data, or survey responses	Include consent, access control, privacy, and cybersecurity planning from the start	Elizabeth
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Table 8: Initial Risks and Mitigation

13. Problem Resolution Process

The purpose of this process is to make sure project issues are not ignored. Problems related to project scope, technical difficulty, research, survey responses, documentation, or team coordination will be recorded and followed up until resolved.

If a problem occurs during the project, the team will follow a simple resolution process to make sure issues are handled quickly and clearly.

Step	Action	Responsible
1. Identify the problem	The team member who notices the issue will raise it during a meeting or on the Notion board.	All members
2. Record the problem	The issue will be added to the task tracker or meeting minutes.	Elizabeth
3. Assign responsibility	The team will decide who is responsible for resolving the problem.	Krish / Relevant member
4. Discuss possible solutions	The team will discuss options and choose the most practical solution.	All members
5. Act	The assigned member will work on resolving the issue.	Assigned member
6. Follow up	The team will review whether the problem has been resolved.	Krish / Elizabeth

Table 9: Problem Resolution Process

13. Approval and Signatures

This Project Charter confirms the project direction, team roles, initial scope, deliverables, and timeline for the Newcastle Smart Peer Companion project.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
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Dr V Sithira Vadivel	Project Sponsor		
Jade Ong	Project Sponsor		
Dr Bobby Chung	Guidance Advisor		
Krish Longwani	Project Manager / AI & Data Engineer		
Alas Elizabeth Louise Flores	Deputy Project Manager/ Documentation Lead & Cybersecurity Support		
Kaung Sett Paing Tun	Database Integration Engineer		
Berezovik Daniil	Front-End & UI Developer		
Hein Myat Thu	Team Member		

Table 10: Approval and Signatures

13. Charter Agreement

By signing this Project Charter, the project sponsors, guidance advisor, and student team acknowledge the proposed project direction, roles, responsibilities, and timeline.

This charter may be updated if the project's scope, requirements, or technical direction changes after sponsoring consultation or academic feedback.